

Addiction Group Powerpoint Reflection

Looking back at the addiction PowerPoint I created a couple of years ago, I can see a lot of areas where I have grown both personally and professionally. At the time, I understood addiction primarily from a psychological and behavioral perspective, but I don't think I fully understood how complex addiction really is. Since creating this presentation, my education and experience have helped me develop a more well-rounded understanding of substance use and the many factors that can contribute to it.

One of the biggest areas of growth for me has been learning not to view addiction as simply a choice or a lack of self-control. I have learned more about how biological, psychological, social, and environmental factors can all play a role in substance use. This has helped me develop more empathy for individuals struggling with addiction and has reinforced the importance of approaching clients without judgment.

I have also grown in my understanding of how important the therapeutic relationship is when working with individuals who struggle with substance use. I used to think more about what interventions or techniques would help someone stop using, but I now understand that building trust and meeting a client where they are is just as important. Motivational interviewing and other approaches have helped me see the value of allowing clients to explore their own reasons for change rather than trying to force change upon them.

Another area of growth has been recognizing that recovery does not always look the same for everyone. There can be setbacks, different treatment approaches, and different paths toward recovery. Overall, looking back at this PowerPoint reminds me of how much I have learned since I created it. It also shows me that growth does not mean that I was wrong before, but that my understanding has become more nuanced as I have gained more education and experience.